

Handy Andy..... by Pap'



George Weiss is recognized as one of the smartest baseball executives in the business. The Yankees' General Manager did nothing to dispel that notion when he appointed Andy Cohen to manage Denver, the New York club's top farm affiliation. Weiss knows that Cohen will do a fine job with the future Yankee greats being developed in Denver. There isn't a more popular manager in the minors than Andrew Howard Cohen. Nature didn't endow Cohen with enough talent and speed to become a big league star but he certainly wasn't short - changed when it came to baseball brains.

Cohen had his chance in the big show, if you can call it a chance, some 30 years ago with the New York Giants. Actually, he was on a spot when Manager John McGraw announced that Cohen was scheduled to play second base for the Giants after Rogers Hornsby had been sold the Boston Braves. son. Imagine, a young rookie moving

in to fill the great Hornsby's shoes! Before Hornsby, the Giants had had Frank Frisch at second base. And before Frisch, Larry Doyle had starred at second. But Manager McGraw had decided that Cohen would fill the bill, so there was nothing for Andy to do but give it a whirl.

And give it a whirl Andy did. He started off hitting close to .300 and fielded well. But as the season wore on, Cohen's batting tailed off and his fielding was unsure. He plainly lacked the speed of a big league second baseman... he just didn't have it for all the great efforts he made.

The Giants sold Cohen to Newark just when the Yankees were starting to develop their great farm system. When the Yankees decided Andy didn't have much of a future with their club, they passed him along to Minneapolis. Back in the Yankee chain, Cohen may have a future with the club, as a manager.